

eLikas
Data Use and Privacy Policy
Version 1.0

Effective Date: [Date when this is added to the app]

This document explains what personal information the eLikas Progressive Web Application ("eLikas," "we," "us") collects, why we collect it, who we share it with, and what rights you have over your own data. It applies to all users of eLikas, including but not limited to Citizens, Government Operator accounts, and Administrators.

We strive to balance individual privacy with the public interest in providing timely, accurate, and reliable disaster information. Any processing of personal information is carried out only to the extent necessary to support these objectives while respecting the rights of our users.

1. Introduction and Scope

eLikas is a capstone project built to support flood hazard awareness and evacuation coordination primarily in San Juan City, Philippines. Because eLikas asks users to submit reports, share their location, and create accounts, it collects personal data. This policy governs that data collection across the app and the system's underlying infrastructure.

This policy does not apply to third-party websites or services you may reach through links from eLikas (for example, if you tap a hotline number to call it, or follow a link to OpenStreetMap's own site). Those services have their own privacy practices.

2. Who We Are

eLikas is developed by a De La Salle-College of Saint Benilde capstone team, acting as the Personal Information Controller (PIC). For the purposes of this project, the development team is the point of contact for all privacy-related questions, requests, and concerns (see Section 13).

In the case that eLikas is turned over to a government partner or any other entity for real-world use, that partner would formally take on the role of Personal Information Controller for user data collected in production, with the development team's role possibly limited to system support. You will be notified and this policy will be updated to reflect that handover.

3. What Information We Collect

We only collect what eLikas needs to function. The table below lists each category of data, examples, and which type of account may provide it.

Category	Examples	Collected From
Account Information	Email address, username, password <i>Only identification information from the provider is known to eLikas (such as a unique user identifier) for authentication purposes.</i>	All registered users
Identity Information	First name, last name	Citizens, Government operators
Contact Information	Mobile phone number	Citizens (optional), Government operators

Location Information	Device location when requesting a route or viewing the in-app map	All users (when enabled)
User-Generated Content	Flood/evacuation reports, comments, votes, uploaded photos, feedback ratings and messages	Citizens, Government operators
Communication Content	Emergency SMS broadcast messages and recipient counts	Government operators
Device & Session Data	Authentication tokens, App Check attestation, basic metadata (e.g., IP addresses, user agent)	All registered users
Administrative Records	Audit logs of in-app activity	All registered users

eLikas does not collect payment information, government ID numbers, precise background location tracking, or any information beyond what is listed above.

4. How We Collect It

- **Directly from you:** when you register, submit content, or update your profile.
- **Device GPS coordinates:** captured only after the app is granted permission on your device and submitted when evacuation routes are requested.
- **Device & Session Data:** recorded upon completion of actions such as creation, editing, and removal of content on the app.
- **From Firebase Authentication:** once you log in, Firebase issues a token that confirms who you are.

5. Why We Collect It, and Your Consent

eLikas processes personal information only for legitimate, specific, and declared purposes related to providing the platform's services.

Depending on the activity involved, processing may be based on your consent, the fulfillment of services you request through the platform, or our legitimate interests in maintaining the security, integrity, and proper operation of eLikas. Where consent is required under applicable law, we will request it clearly before collecting or using your information. You may withdraw consent at any time by deactivating your account (see Section 8), though some information (like audit logs) may be retained as described in Section 7.

Data Collected	Purpose
Email, password	To create and secure your account and to receive important eLikas-related notifications (e.g., content removal notice, platform changes) through email
Name	To personalize your profile and support account-related features within eLikas
Phone number	To send optional emergency SMS alerts and allow Government operators reach you

Location (map view)	To display nearby map-based information such as hazard pins and evacuation centers
Location (routing requests)	To calculate a safe evacuation route from your current position
Social Content (e.g., Comments, votes, photos)	To participate on eLikas' social platform and information sharing within the community
Feedback	To help us improve the system
Audit logs	To maintain accountability for administrative actions and investigate misuse if needed

6. How We Use and Share Your Information

eLikas relies on a small number of external services beyond the Progressive Web App to function. We only share the minimum information necessary for these services to perform their role. The table below lists every external service used by eLikas.

Service	What We Share	Why
Firebase Authentication (Google)	Email address, password (handled entirely by Firebase), device attestation signals (App Check / reCAPTCHA v3)	To verify your identity and mitigate bot/fraudulent account creation
OpenAI Moderation API	Text content users submit to the platform	To screen for harmful or inappropriate content submitted to the platform
IPROGSMS API	Phone number and the broadcast message text (Government operator-initiated alerts only)	To deliver emergency SMS notifications
OpenStreetMap API	None (only map tile requests, no personal data)	To render the base map
BRouter (Hosted independently by the eLikas team)	GPS coordinates only (no account or identity information)	To calculate evacuation routes
Media Storage (Privately and independently managed by eLikas)	Uploaded media	To store and serve media for the platform's various social features

Within eLikas

The information you choose to share through reports, comments, votes, and other community features is visible to other logged-in users by design.

Government Operators may view reports submitted within their jurisdiction for verification and response purposes. Administrators may access user information only where necessary for account administration, moderation, support, security, or other legitimate platform functions.

Display Names

During registration, you choose a display name that becomes your primary identity within eLikas. This display name is shown to other users when interacting with reports, comments, votes, and other community features.

Your real name and contact information are never shown publicly and may be accessed by Administrators when necessary to perform their responsibilities. Phone numbers are only accessible to authorized Government Operators for the stated purpose in this policy when allowed by the user.

While display names help protect your identity, any personal information you voluntarily include in reports, comments, photos, or other public content may still be visible to other users. We encourage you not to share information you would prefer to keep private.

Content Removal

We may remove or restrict access to content that violates our Community Guidelines, applicable law, or poses a risk to the safety, security, or integrity of the platform.

When content is removed, it is immediately hidden from other users but is not permanently deleted right away. Instead, it is retained in an isolated state for a limited period to support moderation, appeals, dispute resolution, security investigations, audit requirements, or legal obligations. Once it is no longer required for these purposes, it is securely deleted or irreversibly anonymized in accordance with our retention practices.

Required Disclosures

We may disclose personal information when required by law, regulation, court order, lawful government request, or other legally binding process. We may also disclose information where reasonably necessary to investigate fraud, security incidents, misuse of the platform, or to protect the rights, safety, or property of our users, the public, or eLikas.

Any disclosure is limited to the information reasonably necessary for the specific purpose.

Third-Party Providers

We never sell your personal information or share it for advertising purposes.

Some service providers listed above may process or store personal information outside the Philippines. Where this occurs, we rely on providers that maintain appropriate technical and organizational safeguards consistent with applicable privacy laws.

We carefully select these providers and disclose only the minimum information necessary for them to perform the services required by eLikas.

7. Data Storage, Retention, and Security

Definitions

For the purposes of this policy:

- **Removed** means content is no longer visible or accessible to other users but may continue to be retained internally for moderation, security, accountability, or legal purposes.
- **Deleted** means personal information or content has been permanently erased or irreversibly anonymized in accordance with our retention practices.

Storage

We store personal information using systems managed by the eLikas team together with the trusted service providers identified in Section 6. Access to personal information and administrative tools is restricted to authorized personnel and limited to what is necessary for them to perform their responsibilities.

Retention

- ***Account Information:*** Your account is deactivated immediately following your request and it stops being usable or visible on the platform. Your identifying information (such as your name, email address information, and phone number) will be anonymized within 30 days of your deletion request, unless a longer retention period is required by law or is necessary to resolve security incidents, legal claims, or accountability obligations, in line with the "no longer than necessary" standard the Data Privacy Act sets for personal data. A platform account identifier may be kept longer when tied to an audit log entry for records as outlined below under the Audit Logs section.
- ***Contributed Content:*** Content such as reports, comments, votes, and uploaded photos remain available only for as long as they serve their intended purpose within eLikas. Once they are no longer needed, they will be anonymized in accordance with our retention practices. Anonymous information that can no longer identify an individual may be retained for system improvement, analytics, or research purposes.
- ***Audit Logs:*** Records are retained for two (2) years from the date of the recorded activity to support security monitoring, misuse investigations, dispute resolution, and administrative accountability. After this period, audit records are securely deleted unless continued retention is required by law or for an ongoing investigation.

Security

We use a combination of administrative, technical, and organizational safeguards to protect the personal information entrusted to us. These measures include:

- ***Secure transmission:*** Personal information is transmitted using encrypted connections provided by industry-standard protocols to help protect data while it is being sent between your device and our services.
- ***Secure authentication:*** User authentication is handled through Firebase, an industry-standard identity provider. Passwords are never stored by eLikas.
- ***Protection against abuse:*** Firebase App Check and reCAPTCHA v3 help ensure requests to our backend come from genuine app instances and legitimate users, reducing automated abuse and fraudulent activity.
- ***Access controls:*** Access to personal information and administrative tools is restricted to authorized personnel and limited to what is necessary for their responsibilities.
- ***Accountability and monitoring:*** Administrative actions and other important system events are logged to support security monitoring, investigations, and accountability.
- ***Content moderation:*** User-submitted content is screened through automated moderation, and users can report inappropriate content for human review.

While no information system can guarantee absolute security, we continuously review and improve our safeguards to protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of personal information.

8. Your Rights as a Data Subject

Under the Data Privacy Act of 2012, you have the following rights over your personal data. We honor all of them:

- ***Right to be informed:*** You have the right to know what data we collect and why (refer to this document).

- **Right to access:** You can request a copy of the personal data we hold about you by reaching out to us.
- **Right to object:** You may object to the processing of your personal information where permitted under applicable law, particularly where processing is based on legitimate interests or for purposes beyond those originally communicated to you.
- **Right to rectification:** You can correct inaccurate information in your profile at any time through Settings.
- **Right to erasure or blocking:** You can request that your account and associated personal data be deactivated or removed, subject to the retention notes in Section 7 (for example, audit log entries referencing your past actions may be retained for accountability even after account deletion).
- **Right to data portability:** You can request your data in a commonly used format.
- **Right to damages:** You may seek compensation if you suffer harm due to inaccurate, unlawful, or unauthorized processing of your data.
- **Right to file a complaint:** You may lodge a complaint directly with the National Privacy Commission (privacy.gov.ph) if you believe your rights under the Data Privacy Act have been violated.

We will respond to requests relating to your personal information within a reasonable period and may ask you to verify your identity before fulfilling certain requests to help protect your privacy and prevent unauthorized access. You may reach out using the contact information in Section 13. For the full legal detail behind each right, the National Privacy Commission keeps a plain-language breakdown at privacy.gov.ph/data-subject-rights.

9. Age Restrictions

eLikas is meant for residents and visitors aged 18 and above. Because eLikas does not independently verify the age declared during registration, we rely on users to provide accurate information. If we become aware that an account was created by someone who does not meet our eligibility requirements, we may suspend or deactivate the account and handle any associated personal information in accordance with this policy.

10. Offline Access and Local Storage

As a Progressive Web App, eLikas caches certain map tiles and evacuation center data directly on your device so that core safety information remains available even without an internet connection. Cached information remains on your device and is not transmitted to eLikas while your device is offline. The cache is refreshed or replaced automatically when the application reconnects to the internet.

11. Data Breach Notification

If a security incident occurs that puts your personal data at real risk of harm, we will notify both the National Privacy Commission and affected users within the prescribed period, including the applicable 72-hour notification requirement. Our notification will explain the nature of the incident, the information involved, the potential impact, and the measures being taken in response.

12. Changes to This Policy

If any significant changes to this policy take effect, this will be reflected in the "Effective Date" above and users may be notified through the app, email, and/or other means. Continued use of eLikas after the updated policy takes effect signifies your acknowledgment of the revised Privacy Policy.

13. Contact Us

For questions, concerns, or requests related to your personal data, or to exercise any of the rights listed in Section 8, please reach out to the eLikas development team:

- **Email:** elikasteam@gmail.com

We are committed to addressing privacy-related concerns fairly, promptly, and in accordance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012. If you have any questions or concerns about how we process your personal information, we encourage you to contact us so we can address them promptly. If you believe your concerns have not been adequately resolved, you also have the right to raise the matter with the National Privacy Commission (NPC) in accordance with applicable law.